
HS 556: Classical Social Theories

Course Code	HS 556
Course Name	Classical Social Theories
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the Course Instructor
Intended for	UG/PG
Distribution	Elective
Approval	9th Senate (May 2016)

Course Contents

- **INTRODUCTION**

- What is social theory
- Historical and Intellectual Contexts
- Various traditions of social anthropology and sociology

Readings

- Appelrouth, Scott and Laura Desfor Edles. 2008. Classical and contemporary sociological theory: Text and readings. California: Pine Forge Press. [It may be used as a textbook for theories in Sociology for undergraduate students].
- Calhoun, Craig et.al. 2007. Classical Social Theory. Blackwell Publishing. [Chapter 2, What is Enlightenment. Pp 39-43].
- Erickson, Paul A. and Liam D. Murphy. 2013. A history of Anthropological theory. Ontario: University of Toronto Press. (Chapter-1).
- Ian Craib. 1997. Introduction: Whats wrong with theory and why we still need it? In Classical Social Theory. New York: Oxford University Press; pp: 3-14.
- Randal Collins and Michael Makowsky. 2010. Introduction: Society and Illusion. In Randal Collins (ed) The Discovery of Society. pp. 1-15.
- **Emile Durkheim (1858-1917)**
 - A Biographical Sketch; intellectual influences and core ideas
 - Functionalism
 - Social Fact, Social solidarity, collective conscience
 - Theories of Religion: sacred and profane, Collective representation
 - Anomie, Suicide

Readings

- Calhoun, Craig et.al. 2007. Classical Social Theory. Blackwell Publishing. Pp 133-202.
- Edles, Laura Desfor and Scott Appelrouth. 2010. Sociological Theory in the Classical Era: Text and Readings. California: Pine Forge Press.
- Lewis A. Coser, 1996. Masters of Sociological Thought. Jaipur: Rawat Publications.
- **Karl Marx** (1818-1883)
 - A Biographical Sketch; intellectual influences and core ideas
 - Capital, Mode of Production, Relations of Production
 - Class Consciousness and Class struggle
 - Alienation/Estrangement, Commodity fetishism
 - Surplus value Theory, Asiatic Mode of Production

Readings

- Cohen, G.A. 2000. Karl Marx's Theory of History. Oxford University Press; pp: 63-87, 364-388.
- Calhoun, Craig et.al. 2007. Classical Social Theory. Blackwell Publishing; pp: 82-120.
- Edles, Laura Desfor and Scott Appelrouth. 2010. Sociological Theory in the Classical Era: Text and Readings. California: Pine Forge Press.
- Lewis A. Coser, 1996. Masters of Sociological Thought. Jaipur: Rawat Publications.
- **Max Weber** (1864- 1920)
 - A Biographical Sketch; intellectual influences and core ideas
 - Social action and Sociology, Verstehen
 - Ideal types, Types of Legitimate Domination, Bureaucracy
 - Class, Status, and party; Protestant Ethic & the Spirit of Capitalism
 - 'Iron cage' of rationality

Readings

- Calhoun, Craig et.al. 2007. Classical Social Theory. Blackwell Publishing. Pp 228-246.
- Edles, Laura Desfor and Scott Appelrouth. 2010. Sociological Theory in the Classical Era: Text and Readings. California: Pine Forge Press.
- Kalberg, Stephan. 2005. Max Weber: readings and commentary on modernity. London: Blackwell Pub. (This book has some good selections from Weber's writings)
- Ritzer, George. 2008. Sociological Theory. Chapter 4, pp 119-121; pp 125-127; pp 136-142.
- Lewis A. Coser, 1996. Masters of Sociological Thought. Jaipur: Rawat Publications.
- **Georg Simmel** (1858-1918)
 - A Biographical Sketch; intellectual influences and core ideas
 - Duality, sociation, the surplus value of wealth

Readings

- Edles, Laura Desfor and Scott Appelrouth. 2010. Sociological Theory in the Classical Era: Text and Readings. California: Pine Forge Press.
- Lewis A. Coser, 1996. Masters of Sociological Thought. Jaipur: Rawat Publications.